

Framing Risk Choice Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Human Sciences • 20-30 min

Category	Human Sciences	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	framing-risk-choice

Big idea: The same evidence can lead to different choices when framed as gain or loss.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students make choices under gain and loss frames, then compare how wording changes apparently rational decisions.

Student Prompt

Inspect Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Gain frame: 200 of 600 people will be saved for sure, or a one-third chance all 600 are saved. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Framing Risk Choice Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Framing Risk Choice Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies. Predict how people will respond, then identify the wording, context, incentive, or role that could change the result.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — The same evidence can lead to different choices when framed as gain or loss.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Framing Risk Choice Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Are decisions based on evidence, framing, or both?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Human Sciences.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how the same evidence can lead to different choices when framed as gain or loss.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Are decisions based on evidence, framing, or both?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare mathematically equivalent gain-frame and loss-frame versions.
- Collect anonymous choices so students examine patterns, not individual judgement.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Gain frame: 200 of 600 people will be saved for sure, or a one-third chance all 600 are saved.
- Loss frame: 400 of 600 people will die for sure, or a one-third chance nobody dies.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/framing-risk-choice/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/framing-risk-choice/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/framing-risk-choice/visual-prompt.svg>
- Two scenario sheets with equivalent outcomes and different wording.
- Class tally table comparing safe/risky choices under each frame.

Run Sequence

1. Randomly give half the class a gain-framed version and half a loss-framed version.
2. Students choose between a certain option and a risky option.
3. Collect anonymous choices and compare class patterns by frame.
4. Reveal that the underlying outcomes were equivalent.
5. Debrief how framing can shape judgement without changing facts.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Are choices based on evidence, framing, or both?
- Can a rational decision be separated from how options are described?

- How do human scientists study hidden influences on judgement?

Teacher Quick Script

- The numbers did not change; the frame did.
- If wording changes choices, what does that reveal about evidence and emotion?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...